

Quality Assessment: Training Guide

Training Goals:

1. The audience will understand that:
 - Quality must be checked and affirmed before a translation is published.
 - Quality assurance is part of Church Ownership: the heart language community is both **responsible** and **uniquely able** to check and affirm their translation's quality.
 - Translators need objective, clearly defined standards as a goal while they translate.
2. The audience will be able to:
 - Guide their team to add standards with definitions and affirming questions to their **Quality Assessment Guide (QAG)** if their community desires (Optional; demonstrated by Exercise 1).
 - Use their **QAG** to check for desired standards in their translation (demonstrated by Exercise 2).

Estimated Time: 60-90 min. discussion and Exercise 1, plus 30-40 min. Exercise 2

Note: This module could be broken into two sessions when training leaders new to translation. A break between Exercises 1 and 2 is recommended.

Materials: ✓ Slides: *Quality Assessment - Slides (Optional)*
✓ **Quality Assessment Guide Chart** (1 copy for each person)
✓ *Quality Assessment Exercise 2* (1 copy for each person)
✓ *Quality Assessment Guide Checklist Sample* (1 copy for each person, if not using slides)

Note to Trainers in Gateway Languages: Exercise 2 CANNOT be translated directly. Prepare Exercise 2 by typing or pasting Matthew 1:18-25 from your ULB into a document and inserting errors. See full instructions in the "*Quality Assessment Exercise 2: Answer Key.*"

 **Ask: What kind of translation did you come here to work on?**

Introduction: Translators tell us that they are dedicated to creating a quality Bible translation. We all agree that quality assurance is important when translating God's Word.

A useful tool to accomplish this is a **Quality Assessment Guide.** A **Quality Assessment Guide** creates a **standard** the whole team can use to ensure the translation's quality. Let's talk a little bit about what this guide is and how you can build one.

 **Ask:**

- **When a local language community has translated Scripture using the 8-Step Translation process, is it ready to be used?**
- **Is that translation complete, or should someone else check it and approve its quality?**

Historical Example: Often, Scripture checking has traditionally relied on how an outside expert, or consultant, thinks about the translation, even though different experts might have different views. In that model, the standard for a quality translation is subject to one expert's view.

 **Ask: What problems might come with this method?**

Possible answers include:

- *This expert consultant might not know the language, so couldn't suggest words.*
- *The expert might not be someone with authority to other believers in the community.*
- *This outside expert probably won't know the culture.*
- *It could take a long time to get an outside expert to come to the village.*

Quality Assessment



Is it ready?



Quality Assessment

Ask:

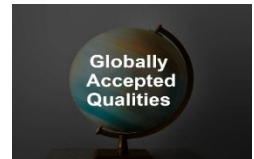
- Who will own your translation?
- Who are the experts in your heart language?

Explain: Wycliffe Associates (WA) does not view itself as the owner of the translation in any language. WA believes instead that the local church owns the translation and the people are the best ones to affirm both quality and naturalness in their heart language.

Guide the team to understand that careful checking is necessary, but the heart language community are the best equipped to do this. Help them see that **quality assurance is part of Church Ownership**. Consider Matthew 28:19-20.

When translators build a **Quality Assessment Guide**, they agree on it as a standard to use when measuring the quality of translated Scripture.

Globally accepted qualities provide good starting points for a **Quality Assessment Guide**.



Ask: If you were a pastor of a small church in a minority-language community and one of your members brought you a Bible translated into that language, what would you think of it? How would you know if it was a good translation?



If a team uses globally accepted standards to check their translation, they will be confident to share it. The team's careful checking lets them know their translation is high quality.

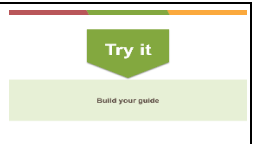
What is a Quality Assessment Guide?

- This Guide is simply a **list of qualities**, starting with globally accepted ones. Each quality has **definitions** that will help translators ask the right **questions** to check their translation.
- This guide will provide the translation team with an **objective standard** they are all committed to uphold **as they translate and check** their drafted Scripture.
- The qualities in a **Quality Assessment Guide** are related to the **content** of the translation, not the process or production. For example: "Must be published with a green cover" is not about the content.

Production features, such as color or page weight, are addressed with a Community Acceptance Plan.

Exercise 1: Building the Guide

The trainer will use the **Quality Assessment Guide Chart** to lead the Exercise. **DO NOT** distribute the *QAG* Chart until AFTER the group has completed the exercise.



Ask: What qualities do you want to be true of your translation?

Most groups mention "accurate" or "natural." Write their answer on the board or worksheet. Then ask them to explain or define each quality.

Explain: There are globally accepted standards that translators, consultants, and other organizations all over the world use to uphold quality in Scripture translation. Sometimes these standards are talked about without being clearly defined or directly applied to translation. This exercise will help explain the globally accepted standards, and how to check the translation to make sure those qualities are upheld.

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- Use white board, easel, or slides to display only the list of globally accepted qualities (do not show definitions or questions). Have the team discuss in groups at tables, if desired.
- Use your own *QAG* to lead discussion about one quality at a time:
 - First, point out how the qualities they thought of are the same as (or similar to) the globally accepted ones.
 - For each quality, ask the group how they would define it. After they discuss, share the definition from the *QAG* and guide the team to understand that definition.
 - Use the questions to help them understand how to check for each quality. If the team made a list of grammar rules for their language during the Checking Steps, remind them to use this list when checking for grammar.
- Once the group has fully discussed these qualities, ask if they have any others they want to add. Discuss any they add.
- When they are confident with the list, give everyone a copy of the *Quality Assessment Guide Chart.*

Quality Assessment Guide		
Example	✓ Definitions	✓ Questions
Accurate		
Faithful		
Idiosyncratic		
Clear		
Natural		
Consistent		
Grammatical		
Other qualities		

Ask:

- What errors do you notice in this sample draft?
- Which quality is missing because of each error?

Lead the team to practice finding the missing qualities on each example slide, **OR** write examples on white board for them to practice. Point out that some errors may impact more than one quality.

Quality Assessment Guide		
Example	✓ Definitions	✓ Questions
Which quality is missing in this sample draft?		
Source text (L&B) (From Matthew 24)		
Sample Draft		
17 Let him who is on the housetop not go down to take anything out of the house.		
18 Let him who is in the field not return to take his cloak.		
19 But now to those who are pregnant and to those who are nursing infants in those days		
20 Pray that your flight will not occur in the winter or on a Sabbath.		
21 Therefore, when you see the abomination of desolation, which was spoken of by the prophet, standing in the holy place" (let the reader understand),		

Quality Assessment Guide	Quality Assessment Guide	Quality Assessment Guide	Quality Assessment Guide	Quality Assessment Guide	Quality Assessment Guide
Example	Example	Example	Example	Example	Example
Which quality is missing in this sample draft?	Which quality is missing in this sample draft?	Which quality is missing in this sample draft?	Which quality is missing in this sample draft?	Which quality is missing in this sample draft?	Which quality is missing in this sample draft?
Source text (L&B) (From Matthew 24)	Source text (L&B) (From Matthew 24)	Source text (L&B) (From Matthew 24)	Source text (L&B) (From Mark 13)	Source text (L&B) (From Mark 13)	Source text (L&B) (From Mark 13)
Sample Draft	Sample Draft	Sample Draft	Sample Draft	Sample Draft	Sample Draft
17 Let him who is on the housetop not go down to take anything out of the house.	17 Let him who is on the housetop not go down to take anything out of the house.	17 Let him who is on the housetop not go down to take anything out of the house.	4 John came, baptizing in the wilderness and preaching a baptism of repentance for the forgiveness of sins.	4 John came, baptizing in the wilderness and preaching a baptism of repentance for the forgiveness of sins.	4 John came, baptizing in the wilderness and preaching a baptism of repentance for the forgiveness of sins.
18 Let him who is in the field not return to take his cloak.	18 Let him who is in the field not return to take his cloak.	18 Let him who is in the field not return to take his cloak.	5 The whole country of Judaea and all the people of Jerusalem went out to him. They were baptized by him in the Jordan River, confessing their sins.	5 The whole country of Judaea and all the people of Jerusalem went out to him. They were baptized by him in the Jordan River, confessing their sins.	5 The whole country of Judaea and all the people of Jerusalem went out to him. They were baptized by him in the Jordan River, confessing their sins.
19 But now to those who are pregnant and to those who are nursing infants in those days	19 But now to those who are pregnant and to those who are nursing infants in those days	19 But now to those who are pregnant and to those who are nursing infants in those days	6 John wore a coat of camel's hair and a leather belt around his waist, and he ate locusts and wild honey.	6 John wore a coat of camel's hair and a leather belt around his waist, and he ate locusts and wild honey.	6 John wore a coat of camel's hair and a leather belt around his waist, and he ate locusts and wild honey.
20 Pray that your flight will not occur in the winter or on a Sabbath.	20 Pray that your flight will not occur in the winter or on a Sabbath.	20 Pray that your flight will not occur in the winter or on a Sabbath.	7 Therefore, when you see the abomination of desolation, which was spoken of by the prophet, standing in the holy place" (let the reader understand),	7 Therefore, when you see the abomination of desolation, which was spoken of by the prophet, standing in the holy place" (let the reader understand),	7 Therefore, when you see the abomination of desolation, which was spoken of by the prophet, standing in the holy place" (let the reader understand),
21 Therefore, when you see the abomination of desolation, which was spoken of by the prophet, standing in the holy place" (let the reader understand),	21 Therefore, when you see the abomination of desolation, which was spoken of by the prophet, standing in the holy place" (let the reader understand),	21 Therefore, when you see the abomination of desolation, which was spoken of by the prophet, standing in the holy place" (let the reader understand),			

Explain: Quality assurance starts during the Eight Steps. A translation can achieve a higher quality when translators use the *Quality Assessment Guide* as an objective standard to check their own work every time they create a draft. (This also improves the translators' skill as they repeatedly focus on their goals.) Then, during Refinement, the *QAG Checklist* helps translators check that these goals were consistently met throughout the entire translation. Notice that consistency is a major part of quality. It is not a separate category, but it applies to every category.

Remember that there are many checking and refinement steps because each step applies a different filter to check the translation. The *QAG* lists your goals. Some of these qualities will be broken down later into even more detailed checks.

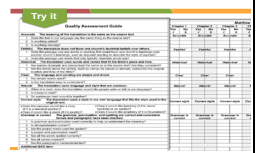
Show the checklist on the next slide and explain that teams who publish through WA must physically fill out each column during Refinement, and present the completed checklist before going on to the next Refinement step. If you are training a team in Eight Step Translation, they do not need to complete the checklist at this time, but help them to understand that quality assurance begins now. They will save much time and effort if they use their *QAG* for checking from the beginning. Encourage them to take it seriously.

Note: If the team is in a region that struggles with Divine Familial Terms (DFTs), this may be a good place to explain the connection between DFTs and quality. These terms impact qualities such as accuracy and faithfulness. DFTs are explained thoroughly in another session.

Quality Assessment

Exercise 2: Practice Using the Guide

Hand out *[Quality Assessment Exercise 2: Practice Using the Guide](#).* The “Sample Draft” column has **intentional errors** for the trainees to find.



A thumbnail image of a document titled "Quality Assessment Exercise 2: Practice Using the Guide". It shows a table with columns for "Sample Draft", "Source Text", and "Quality Assessment". The "Sample Draft" column contains text with intentional errors for trainees to find.

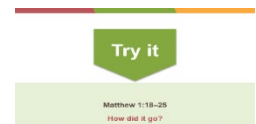
Display the sample checklist slide, or hand out *[Quality Assessment Guide Checklist Sample](#)* for the team to use during the Exercise. **Explain that this checklist will be a required step in their Refinement if they publish through WA.**

Instructions to trainees: Compare the “Sample Draft” to the ULB “Source Text.” Use your *[Quality Assessment Guide](#)* to check for errors.

After everyone has finished, review the exercise with the entire group. An **Answer Key** with highlighted errors is included at the end of this walkthrough to help you review. You do not need to point out all the errors. Instead, use the discussion time to review what they found and to encourage teamwork in finding errors. If there are disagreements about how something should be corrected, encourage them to find consensus.

Ask:

- Did your *[Quality Assessment Guide](#)* help you find these errors?
- Which qualities or questions helped you to find these errors?



Confirm:

1. The audience understands that:

- Quality must be checked and affirmed before a translation is published.
- Quality assurance is part of Church Ownership: the heart language community is both **responsible** and **uniquely able** to check and affirm their translation's quality.
- Translators need objective, clearly defined standards as a goal while they translate.

2. The audience is able to:

- Guide their team to add standards with definitions and affirming questions to their *[QAG](#)* if their community desires (Optional; demonstrated by Exercise 1).
- Use their *[QAG](#)* to check for desired standards in their translation (demonstrated by Exercise 2).



Quality Assessment Guide Chart

Chapter/Section: _____

Qualities	Definitions	Yes/No Questions
Accurate	The meaning of the translation is the same as the source text.	Does the text in our language say the same thing as the source text? Is anything added? Is anything missing?
Faithful	The translation does not favor one church's doctrinal beliefs over others.	Does the passage use any words or wording that could favor one church's teachings over another church's teachings, such as adjusted wording to describe the style of baptism? Does the passage use words that only specific churches would use?
Historical	The translation uses words and names that fit the Bible's place and time.	Are names of people and places kept the same as in the source text? Are they consistent? Are the words about the setting, such as names for places or animals, correct for the original location and time of the Bible?
Clear	The language and wording are simple and direct.	Are simple words used? Is the translation easy to understand?
Natural	The translation uses language and style that are common.	When it is read, does the translation sound like people write or talk in our language? Is it easy to read? Do sentences read smoothly together?
Correct style	The translation uses a style in our own language that fits the style used in the original text.	Does the passage sound like a story (if it is a narrative portion)? Does it sound like a poem (if it is poetry)? Does it sound like teaching (if it is Jesus' teaching or an epistle)? Does it sound like prophecy (if it is Revelation)?
Grammar is correct	The grammar, punctuation, and spelling are correct and consistent. Verses and paragraphs have been checked.	Are grammar and punctuation used correctly to help us understand the meaning? Is all capitalization correct? Is the proper format used for quotes? Is proper end punctuation used? Are all words spelled correctly? Are all verses marked? Are the paragraphs marked/indented?

Quality Assessment Exercise 2: Practice Using the Guide

Instructions: Read through this passage, comparing the draft to the source text. Use your *Quality Assessment Guide* to check for errors. When you and others in the group are confident you have caught the errors, the trainer will guide you through checking your work.

Matthew 1:18–25 **Source Text (ULB)**

18 The birth of Jesus Christ happened in the following way. His mother, Mary, was engaged to marry Joseph, but before they came together, she was found to be pregnant by the Holy Spirit.

19 But Joseph, her husband, was a righteous man and did not want to publicly disgrace her, so he intended to divorce her quietly.

20 As he thought about these things, an angel of the Lord appeared to him in a dream, saying, “Joseph son of David, do not fear to take Mary as your wife, because the one who is conceived in her is conceived by the Holy Spirit.

21 She will bear a son, and you will call his name Jesus, for he will save his people from their sins.”

22 Now all this happened to fulfill what was spoken by the Lord through the prophet, saying,

23 “Behold, the virgin will become pregnant and will bear a son, and they will call his name Immanuel”—which being translated is “God with us.”

24 Joseph got up from his sleep and did as the angel of the Lord commanded him, and he took her as his wife.

25 But he did not know her until she gave birth to a son. Then he called his name Jesus.

Matthew 1:18–25 **Sample Draft**

18 The birth of Jesus Christ happened in the following way. His mother, Marry, was engaged to marry Joseph, but before they came together, she was found to be pregnant by the Spirit.

19 But Joseph, her husband, was a meritorious man and did not want to publicly disgrace her, so he intended to divorce her quietly.

20 As he thought about these things, an angel of the Lord appeared to him in a dream, saying, "Joe son of David, do not fear to take Mary as your wife, because the one who is conceived in her is conceived by the Holy Spirit.

21 She will bear a child, and you will call his name Jesus, for he will save his people from their sins.

22 Now all this happened to fulfill what was spoken by the lord through the prophet, saying,

23 "Behold, the virgin will become pregnant and will bear a son, and they will call his name Immanuel.”

24 Joseph up from his sleep arose and did as the angel of the Lord commanded him, and he took her as his wife.

25 But he did not know her until she gave birth to a son in Bethlehem. Then he called his name Jesus.

Quality Assessment Guide Checklist Sample

Quality Assessment Guide		Matthew	
		Chapter 1	
		Yes ✓	No X
Accurate. The meaning of the translation is the same as the source text.		Accurate	
1. Does the text in our language say the same thing as the source text?			
2. Is anything added?			
3. Is anything missing?			
Faithful. The translation does not favor one church's doctrinal beliefs over others.		Faithful	
1. Does the passage use any words or wording that could favor one church's teachings over another church's teachings, such as adjusted wording to describe the style of baptism?			
2. Does the passage use words that only specific churches would use?			
Historical. The translation uses words and names that fit the Bible's place and time.		Historical	
1. Are names of people and places kept the same as in the source text? Are they consistent?			
2. Are the words about the setting, such as names for places or animals, correct for the original location and time of the Bible?			
Clear. The language and wording are simple and direct.		Clear	
1. Are simple words used?			
2. Is the translation easy to understand?			
Natural. The translation uses language and style that are common.		Natural	
1. When it is read, does the translation sound like people write or talk in our language?			
2. Is it easy to read?			
3. Do sentences read smoothly together?			
Correct style. The translation uses a style in our own language that fits the style used in the original text.		Correct Style	
- Does the passage sound like a story (if it is a narrative portion)? - Does it sound like a poem (if it is poetry)?		- Does it sound like teaching (if it is Jesus' teaching or an epistle)? - Does it sound like prophecy (if it is Revelation)?	
Grammar is correct. The grammar, punctuation, and spelling are correct and consistent. Verses and paragraphs have been checked.		Grammar is Correct	
1. Are grammar and punctuation used correctly to help us understand the meaning?			
2. Is all capitalization correct?			
3. Are the proper marks used for quotes?			
4. Is proper end punctuation used?			
5. Are all the words spelled correctly?			
6. Are all verses marked?			
7. Are the paragraphs marked/indented?			
Additional QAG item:			
1.			
2.			
Additional QAG item:			
1.			
2.			

Any needed changes should be made in BTT Writer before each item is marked as correct.

Note to Trainers in Gateway Languages: To prepare Exercise 2, use Matthew 1:18-25 in your source language ULB. Paste that passage into a document and insert errors so that the team can practice using the QAG to check for errors. On a separate page, keep track of the errors you inserted. **DO NOT** translate the exercise, which was created from the English ULB.

Try to insert at least one error for each quality listed on the team's Quality Assessment Guide. (Some errors will reflect more than one category.) Here are some examples:

- For **"Accurate,"** use a word or phrase that adds, leaves out, or changes information. (In English, we used "spirit" instead of "Holy Spirit," "child" instead of "son," and left out part of a sentence. We also added information about Bethlehem that is from another passage, but is not in this passage.)
- For **"Faithful,"** use a word that would only be used in some denominations. (In English, we might use "meritorious" instead of "righteous" for Joseph, or call Mary a queen.)
- For **"Historical,"** use a word that does not clearly reflect the original setting. (In English, we used the modern nickname "Joe" for Joseph.)
- For **"Clear,"** express something in a way that makes the meaning confusing. (In English, we changed word order so that the meaning was hard to understand.)
- For **"Natural,"** use wording that sounds strange or awkward to a native speaker. (In English, we used an uncommon word and changed word order to make one sentence sound odd.)
- For **"Correct Style,"** change the writing level or the type of writing. For example, the narrative can be changed to sound like poetry or prophecy.
- For **"Correct Grammar,"** add an error in spelling, word form, or punctuation, or choose a common error from the team's list of grammar rules for their language. (In English, we misspelled "Mary," used lowercase for "lord," and left out an end quotation mark.)

Trainer Answers for English Quality Assessment Exercise 2:

Following is the passage with the mistakes highlighted.

Matthew 1:18–25

18 The birth of Jesus Christ happened in the following way. His mother, **Marry**, was engaged to marry Joseph, but before they came together, she was found to be pregnant by the **(Holy is missing from the text)** Spirit.

19 But Joseph, her husband, was a **meritorious** (this is not simple, common language; the word "righteous" would also be more faithful because it does not communicate earned favor with God) man and did not want to publicly disgrace her, so he intended to divorce her quietly.

20 As he thought about these things, an angel of the Lord appeared to him in a dream, saying, **"Joe (not an historically accurate name of Joseph)** son of David, do not fear to take Mary as your wife, because the one who is conceived in her is conceived by the Holy Spirit.

21 She will bear a **child (son is more specific than child)**, and you will call his name Jesus, for he will save his people from their sins."

22 Now all this happened to fulfill what was spoken by the **lord (L should be capitalized)** through the prophet, saying,

23 "Behold, the virgin will become pregnant and will bear a son, and they will call his name Immanuel"—which being translated is "God with us." (this phrase is missing)

24 Joseph **up from his sleep arose** (does not sound like a native English speaker) and did as the angel of the Lord commanded him, and he took her as his wife.

25 But he did not know her until she gave birth to a son **in Bethlehem** (extra information that should be deleted). Then he called his name Jesus.